

going to be paying between 1 and 2 percent in fees on the money you ask your advisor to manage. If the advisor has been providing good performance and preserving capital simultaneously, it's worth it.

6. **Monitor performance and fees.** The institution that your investment advisor works for is going to send you a statement every month. Read it. You want to monitor two metrics. First, check to see that your capital is being preserved while you are being paid dividends and interest. Second, check that your advisor is sticking to the rules you both agreed to when you started working together. For example, has any holding in your portfolio grown over a 5 percent weighting, and are you still 50 percent in stocks and 50 percent in bonds? I recommend that you meet with your advisor at least twice a year to go over your portfolio in person, and never hesitate to pick up the phone and call if you have a question. That's service you're paying for.

If you follow these rules and you keep your spending within reason while you are retired, you will sleep with the comfort that your money will outlive you. This will guarantee that people will show up for the reading of your will!

Money Mistake: *The House, Boat or Vacation Property Is in Your Name*

The Fix: *All Assets Should be Jointly Owned*

While I strongly urge you to keep your own accounts and work with your own investment advisor, if you are married I suggest doing exactly the opposite with regard to your assets. This is where you tag-team it—especially with the big purchases. It is absolutely imperative when you and your partner buy a home that it be in both of your names. Never let your spouse tell you it's better if it's only in your name because of the liabilities of his or her job. For example, let's say your wife is in a high-risk profession. Maybe she's a plastic surgeon at perpetual risk of a medical malpractice suit. Together